FIGHTERBASE

Balanced

Food list

Every allowed and avoided food, by type. A bit of everything, in sensible portions.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this food list

This food list is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Balanced**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

The colour key

Green	Amber	Red	Blue
Allowed. Fits this style.	In moderation, small amounts or some versions.	Avoid. The reason is shown.	Check the label or how it is made.
373 allowed	**132** in moderation	**0** avoid	**0** check label

Brand products vary. This list is built from the FighterBase food catalogue of 505 common foods. If a food is not here, ask which group it belongs to and check the label.

AT A GLANCE

Balanced on one page

No food groups cut out. Meals are built from protein, carbs, veg and some fat, with treats kept occasional. The style most sports nutrition guidance starts from.

Mostly yes

- Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet)
- Beef mince (5% to 20% fat)
- Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild)
- Trout
- Hen eggs (whole)
- Egg whites (carton)
- Spinach
- Kale
- Carrots
- Beetroot
- Strawberries
- Blueberries
- Almonds
- Walnuts
- Extra virgin olive oil
- Olive oil (light)

Mostly no

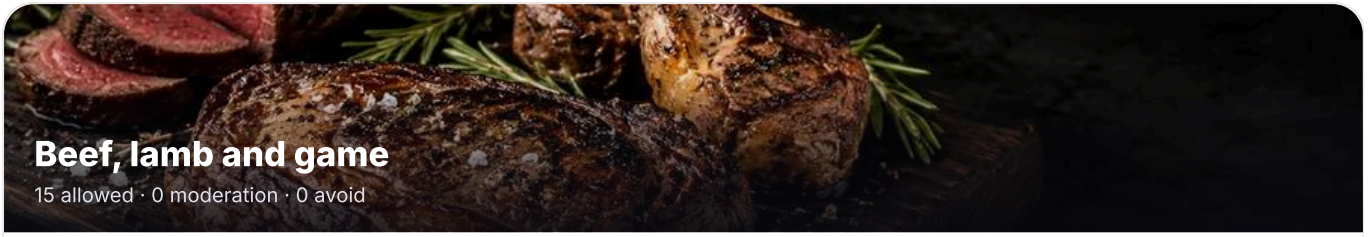
The big ideas

1. Build most meals from four parts: a protein, a starchy carb, vegetables or fruit, and a little fat.
2. No food group is cut out and no food is banned.
3. Treats and takeaways are part of life, just not most of the week.
4. Drink mostly water, tea and coffee without sugar.
5. Eat regularly enough that you are not starving by evening.

Talk to a professional first if: You have a medical condition, allergy or intolerance that changes what you can eat; You are pregnant or breastfeeding; You are under 18 and training heavily (a coach or GP can point you to a sports dietitian).

THE FULL LIST

Every food, by type



Beef, lamb and game

15 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 15

Beef steak (sirloin, rump, ribeye, fillet) · Beef mince (5% to 20% fat) · Beef joint (topside, brisket, silverside) · Beef short ribs and oxtail · Beef burgers (home-made, 100% beef) · Lamb chops, leg and shoulder · Lamb mince · Mutton · Goat · Venison · Rabbit · Wild boar · Bison and buffalo · Pheasant, partridge and grouse · Veal



Pork and cured meats

5 allowed · 9 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 5

Pork loin, chops and tenderloin · Pork belly and pork shoulder · Pork mince · Gammon and ham joint · Lard

MODERATION 9

Bacon (back and streaky) · processed · Sausages (pork) · processed · Sausages (beef or chicken, check the label) · processed · Ham slices (deli) · processed · Salami, chorizo and pepperoni · processed · Pork pies and scotch eggs · processed · Pate and liver sausage · processed · Black pudding · processed · Pulled pork (ready-made, sweetened sauce) · processed



Poultry

8 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 8

Chicken breast · Chicken thighs and drumsticks (skin on or off) · Whole roast chicken · Chicken wings · Chicken mince · Turkey breast and turkey mince · Duck breast and duck leg · Goose

MODERATION 3

Chicken nuggets and breaded chicken · processed · Chicken sausages and deli chicken slices · processed · Rotisserie chicken (shop-bought, check seasoning) · processed



Offal and bones

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Liver (beef, lamb, chicken) · Kidney · Heart · Tongue · Tripe · Bone marrow · Bone broth (home-made) · Beef dripping and tallow · Duck fat and goose fat · Gelatine and collagen powder



Fish

26 allowed · 5 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 26

Salmon (fresh, farmed or wild) · Trout · Mackerel · Sardines (fresh or tinned in oil or water) · Herring and kippers · Anchovies · Pilchards · Tuna (fresh steak) · Tuna (tinned) · Cod · Haddock · Pollock and coley · Plaice and sole · Sea bass and sea bream · Halibut and turbot · Hake · Whitebait · Skate · Monkfish · Swordfish · Catfish · Eel · Shark · Sturgeon and caviar · Fish roe (cod roe, salmon roe) · Cod liver oil

MODERATION 5

Smoked salmon · processed · Fish fingers and breaded fish · processed · Fish cakes · processed · Fish paste and pate · processed · Surimi and crab sticks · processed



Shellfish and seafood

13 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 13

Prawns and shrimp · King prawns and tiger prawns · Crab · Lobster · Langoustine and crayfish · Mussels · Oysters · Scallops · Clams and cockles · Whelks and winkles · Squid and calamari · Octopus · Cuttlefish



Eggs

6 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 6

Hen eggs (whole) · Egg whites (carton) · Duck eggs · Quail eggs · Omelette and scrambled egg · Egg noodles

MODERATION 2

Mayonnaise · processed · Meringue · added sugar



Milk and cream

10 allowed · 1 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Whole milk · Semi-skimmed and skimmed milk · Lactose-free milk · Goat's milk and sheep's milk · Single, double and whipping cream · Soured cream and creme fraiche · Milk powder · Butter · Ghee (clarified butter) · Buttermilk

MODERATION 1

Condensed and evaporated milk · added sugar



Yoghurt, kefir and soft cheeses

11 allowed · 1 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 11

Plain natural yoghurt · Greek yoghurt · Skyr · Kefir · Cottage cheese · Quark · Cream cheese · Ricotta · Mascarpone · Mozzarella · Paneer

MODERATION 1

Flavoured and fruit yoghurt · added sugar



Hard and mature cheeses

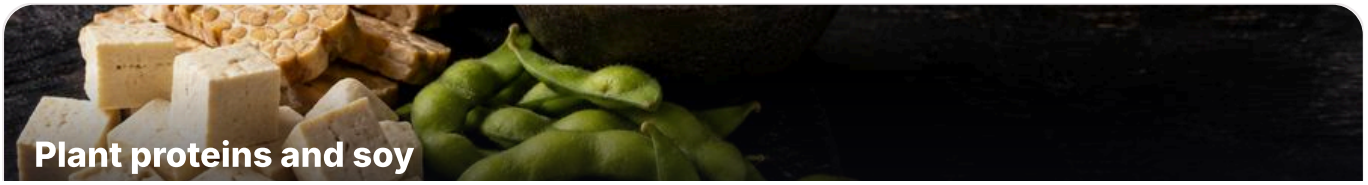
9 allowed · 6 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 9

Cheddar · Parmesan and grana padano (animal rennet) · Edam and gouda · Emmental and gruyere · Brie and camembert · Blue cheese (stilton, gorgonzola) · Feta · Halloumi · Goat's cheese

MODERATION 6

Processed cheese slices and spreads · processed · Whey protein · processed · Casein protein · processed · Ice cream · added sugar · Custard and milk puddings · added sugar · Milkshakes · added sugar



Plant proteins and soy



8 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 8

Tofu (firm, silken, smoked) · Tempeh · Edamame · Soya milk and soya yoghurt · Seitan (wheat protein) · Nutritional yeast · Miso · Natto

MODERATION 4

Soya mince and soya chunks · processed

Quorn and mycoprotein (many contain egg white) · processed

Plant-based burgers and sausages · processed

Pea protein and rice protein powder · processed



Beans, lentils and pulses

20 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 20

Red lentils · Green and brown lentils · Puy lentils · Chickpeas · Black beans · Kidney beans · Cannellini and haricot beans · Butter beans · Pinto beans · Borlotti beans · Broad beans · Black-eyed peas · Split peas · Lupin beans · Hummus · Peanuts · Peanut butter · Green beans and runner beans · Garden peas and petits pois · Mangetout and sugar snap peas

MODERATION 4

Falafel · processed

Baked beans in tomato sauce · added sugar

Refried beans · processed

Bean and lentil pasta · processed



Bread and bakery

14 allowed · 12 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 14

Wholemeal and granary bread · Sourdough bread · Rye bread · Seeded bread · Pitta and flatbreads · Wraps and tortillas (wheat) · Corn tortillas · Naan and chapati · Bagels · Crumpets and muffins · Oatcakes · Almond-flour bread and wraps · Coconut-flour wraps · Cloud bread

MODERATION 12

White bread · processed

Gluten-free bread · processed

Croissants and pastries · added sugar

Pizza base · processed

Crackers and crispbreads · processed

Rice cakes · processed

Cakes and sponge · added sugar

Biscuits and cookies · added sugar

Doughnuts · added sugar

Pies and pasties · processed

Cereal bars and flapjacks · added sugar

Protein bars · added sugar



Pasta, rice and grains

36 allowed · 5 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 36

Wheat pasta (white or wholewheat) · Egg pasta and fresh pasta · Noodles (wheat) and ramen · Rice noodles · Glass noodles · Couscous · Bulgur wheat · Semolina · Freekeh, spelt, farro and kamut · Barley and pearl barley · White rice (basmati, jasmine, long-grain) · Brown rice · Wild rice · Risotto rice · Oats (rolled and porridge) · Oat bran · Shredded wheat and wheat biscuits · Quinoa · Buckwheat · Amaranth · Millet · Sorghum · Teff · Polenta and cornmeal · Sweetcorn and corn on the cob · Popcorn · Chia pudding · Cauliflower rice · Courgette noodles (courgetti) · Konjac (shirataki) noodles · Flours: wheat and plain · Flours: rice, cornflour and maize · Flours: almond · Flours: coconut · Flours: chickpea (gram) · Flours: tapioca and arrowroot

MODERATION 5

Gluten-free pasta (corn or rice) · processed · Sushi rice · added sugar · Muesli and granola · added sugar · Breakfast cereals (cornflakes, bran flakes) · added sugar · Tortilla chips · processed



Leafy and salad vegetables

12 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 12

Spinach · Kale · Cabbage (green, red, savoy) · Spring greens and collards · Lettuce and salad leaves · Rocket and watercress · Chard · Pak choi and bok choy · Cucumber · Celery · Radishes · Bean sprouts



Cruciferous and stalk vegetables

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Broccoli · Cauliflower · Brussels sprouts · Asparagus · Fennel · Artichoke · Kohlrabi · Leeks · Courgette and marrow · Aubergine



Onions, peppers and tomatoes

10 allowed · 0 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Onions and shallots · Garlic · Spring onions and chives · Peppers (red, green, yellow) · Chillies · Tomatoes (fresh, tinned, passata) · Tomato puree · Mushrooms (all types) · Olives · Avocado



Roots, squash and starchy vegetables

22 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 22

Carrots · Beetroot · Parsnips · Swede and turnip · Celeriac · Butternut squash and pumpkin · Sweet potato · White potatoes (boiled, baked, mashed) · Chips (home-made, oven) · Roast potatoes · Yam · Cassava (yuca) and tapioca · Plantain · Taro · Jerusalem artichoke · Seaweed and nori · Sauerkraut · Kimchi · Pickles and gherkins · Frozen vegetables (plain) · Tinned vegetables (no added sugar) · Vegetable juice

MODERATION 2

Chips and fries (takeaway or frozen) · processed

Parsnip and potato crisps (vegetable crisps) · processed



Fruit

28 allowed · 8 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 28

Strawberries · Blueberries · Raspberries · Blackberries · Cranberries and redcurrants · Lemons and limes · Apples · Pears · Oranges and satsumas · Grapefruit · Peaches and nectarines · Plums · Apricots · Cherries · Kiwi · Melon (cantaloupe, honeydew) · Watermelon · Pineapple · Mango · Papaya · Grapes · Bananas · Figs (fresh) · Pomegranate · Passion fruit · Coconut (fresh flesh) · Smoothies (home-made, whole fruit) · Coconut water

MODERATION 8

Dates · added sugar

Raisins, sultanas and currants · added sugar

Dried apricots, figs and prunes · added sugar

Other dried fruit and fruit leather · added sugar

Tinned fruit in juice · added sugar

Tinned fruit in syrup · added sugar

Fruit juice · added sugar

Smoothies (shop-bought) · added sugar



Nuts and seeds

21 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 21

Almonds · Walnuts · Cashews · Pecans · Hazelnuts · Brazil nuts · Macadamias · Pistachios · Pine nuts · Chestnuts · Mixed nuts (plain) · Chia seeds · Flaxseed (linseed) · Hemp seeds · Pumpkin seeds · Sunflower seeds · Sesame seeds and tahini · Poppy seeds · Almond butter · Cashew butter · Coconut flakes and desiccated coconut

MODERATION 3

Salted and flavoured nuts · processed
Trail mix (with dried fruit and chocolate) · added sugar
Hazelnut chocolate spread · added sugar



Oils, fats and spreads

13 allowed · 4 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 13

Extra virgin olive oil
Olive oil (light)
Avocado oil
Coconut oil
MCT oil
Flaxseed oil
Walnut oil
Sesame oil
Rapeseed (canola) oil
Sunflower oil
Vegetable oil and corn oil
Soybean oil
Palm oil

MODERATION 4

Margarine and baking spreads · processed
Dairy-free spreads · processed
Cooking spray · processed
Salad dressings (bottled) · added sugar



Sugars, sweeteners and sweet foods

6 allowed · 19 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 6

Stevia
Monk fruit
Erythritol and xylitol
Aspartame, sucralose and saccharin
Dark chocolate 85% or higher
Cocoa powder (unsweetened)

MODERATION 19

White and brown sugar · added sugar
Honey · added sugar
Maple syrup · added sugar
Agave syrup · added sugar
Golden syrup, treacle and molasses · added sugar
Date syrup and date paste · added sugar
Coconut sugar · added sugar
Jam, marmalade and fruit spreads · added sugar
Milk chocolate · added sugar
Dark chocolate 70% or higher · added sugar
White chocolate · added sugar
Sweets, gummies and jelly · added sugar
Marshmallows · added sugar
Fizzy and boiled sweets · added sugar
Energy gels and chews · added sugar
Sherbet and candyfloss · added sugar
Fruit pastilles and wine gums · added sugar
Protein ice cream and low-sugar desserts · processed
Vegan chocolate · added sugar



Herbs, spices and flavourings

16 allowed · 3 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 16

Salt (sea, table, rock)
Black pepper
Basil, oregano, thyme and rosemary
Parsley, coriander, mint and dill
Sage, bay and tarragon
Cumin, coriander seed and fennel seed
Turmeric
Paprika and smoked paprika
Chilli flakes and cayenne
Cinnamon, nutmeg and cloves
Ginger (fresh and ground)
Garlic powder and onion powder
Mustard seeds
Vanilla (pods)
Curry powder and garam masala (check blends)
Mixed herbs and Italian seasoning

MODERATION 3

Vanilla extract (alcohol-based) · alcohol
Seasoning mixes and rubs (check label) · processed
Stock cubes and gravy granules · processed



Sauces and condiments

15 allowed · 13 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 15

Mustard (English, Dijon, wholegrain)
Soy sauce
Tamari (wheat-free soy sauce)
Coconut aminos
Fish sauce
Worcestershire sauce
Hot sauce (chilli)
Apple cider vinegar
White wine, red wine and rice vinegar
Malt vinegar
Pesto (basil and pine nut)
Dairy-free pesto
Salsa
Guacamole
Gravy (home-made, no flour)

MODERATION 13

Tomato ketchup · added sugar
Brown sauce · added sugar
BBQ sauce · added sugar
Mayonnaise (light) · processed
Oyster sauce · added sugar
Sriracha · added sugar
Balsamic vinegar · added sugar
Curry sauce (jar) · added sugar
Pasta sauce (jar) · added sugar
Sweet chilli sauce · added sugar
Teriyaki sauce · added sugar
Hoisin sauce · added sugar
Coleslaw (shop-bought) · added sugar



Drinks

14 allowed · 13 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 14

Water (still and sparkling)
Tea (black, green, white)
Herbal and fruit teas
Coffee (black)
Coffee with milk or cream
Decaffeinated coffee and tea
Electrolyte tablets and powders (sugar-free)
Oat milk
Almond, cashew and hazelnut milk
Coconut milk drink
Rice milk
Pea milk
Alcohol-free beer
Bone broth drink

MODERATION 13

Hot chocolate · added sugar
Squash and cordial · added sugar
Fizzy drinks (cola, lemonade) · added sugar
Diet and zero-sugar fizzy drinks · processed
Energy drinks · added sugar
Sports drinks · added sugar
Kombucha · added sugar
Beer and lager · alcohol
Cider · alcohol
Wine (red, white, rose) · alcohol
Spirits (whisky, gin, vodka, rum) · alcohol
Liqueurs and alcopops · alcohol
Gluten-free beer · alcohol



Ready meals and takeaway

5 allowed · 13 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 5

Sushi
Home-made vegetable soup
Jacket potato with filling
Salad with grilled chicken
Stir-fry (home-made)

MODERATION 13

Pizza · processed | Burgers in buns · processed | Kebabs · processed | Fish and chips · processed | Takeaway curry with rice · processed | Chinese takeaway · added sugar | Sandwiches and subs · processed | Crisps · processed | Pot noodles and instant noodles · processed | Ready meals · processed | Tinned soup (check label) · processed | Sausage rolls · processed | Burrito and fajitas · processed



Supplements

10 allowed · 2 moderation · 0 avoid

ALLOWED 10

Creatine monohydrate | Fish oil (omega-3) | Algae omega-3 | Vitamin D3 (from lanolin) | Vitamin D (from lichen) | Multivitamin and mineral tablet | Magnesium | Caffeine tablets | BCAAs and EAAs | Collagen peptides

MODERATION 2

Pea or rice protein · processed | Soy protein · processed

READ THE LABEL

Hidden ingredients

Ingredients can hide in the small print. Look for these on packaging, menus and supplements.

- Added sugar: sucrose, glucose syrup, fructose, honey, dextrose
- High salt: more than 1.5 g salt per 100 g is high
- Saturated fat: more than 5 g per 100 g is high (UK traffic-light labels)

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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